# Construction Site Safety: Working at Height

Training document for the SafeSite Assistant RAG exercise

Important note: This is fictional training material prepared for software testing and learning. It is not official regulatory guidance. Verify legal requirements against the applicable jurisdiction and competent safety advice.

## 1. Purpose and scope

This training document describes basic planning and control measures for construction work where a person could fall from an elevated surface. It is an educational sample for testing document retrieval, not a substitute for applicable laws, site-specific risk assessments, or competent safety advice.

## 2. Planning the work

Before work at height begins, a competent supervisor should assess the task, identify fall hazards, and choose equipment appropriate to the work. Where practicable, plan the work so that it can be completed from a safe position without exposure to a fall.

Inspect the work area for fragile roofs, unprotected edges, openings, unstable surfaces, overhead hazards, and access problems. Keep unauthorized people away from the work zone and agree how tools and materials will be moved safely.

## 3. Scaffolds and edge protection

Scaffolds should be erected, altered, and dismantled by trained and authorized personnel under suitable supervision. Before use, a competent person should inspect the scaffold and confirm that it is stable, properly supported, and suitable for the intended load.

Where a person could fall from an exposed platform or edge, provide suitable collective protection such as guardrails, intermediate rails, and toe boards where required by the risk assessment and applicable rules. The exact height at which guardrails become mandatory depends on the governing jurisdiction and site requirements; this sample does not specify a universal threshold.

Do not remove guardrails or other protective components without authorization and a safe alternative control. Keep platforms clear of unnecessary materials and maintain safe access.

## 4. Personal protective equipment (PPE)

Select PPE based on the task-specific risk assessment. Depending on the work, this may include a hard hat, safety footwear, eye protection, gloves, hearing protection, and a suitable fall-arrest system.

A fall-arrest harness is not a substitute for guardrails where collective protection is reasonably practicable. Workers who use fall-arrest equipment must be trained, equipment must be inspected, and a workable rescue plan must be in place before the task starts.

## 5. Inspection and stopping work

Inspect access equipment before use and after events that could affect its condition. Stop work if a scaffold is damaged, a platform is unstable, weather conditions make the task unsafe, or required protection is missing.

Report hazards promptly to the supervisor. Do not improvise repairs or continue work while a serious uncontrolled fall hazard remains.

## 6. Questions this document can answer

What should happen before work at height begins? A task-specific risk assessment and planning by a competent supervisor should take place.

Can a harness replace guardrails in every situation? No. Collective protection should be considered first where reasonably practicable.

Does this document give a universal legal height for mandatory guardrails? No. The applicable jurisdiction and site rules must be checked.

End of document.